Aotearoa: Biculturalism and the Maori Way of Life

Target Audience: B1+ / B2 (Upper-Intermediate)
Time: 45-50 minutes
Approach: CLIL + Socio-cultural approach
Lesson Objectives:

- Educational (Content): Understand the concept of biculturalism in New Zealand, the historical significance of the Treaty of Waitangi (1840), and key elements of Maori culture (language, Haka, Marae).
- Linguistic (Language): Practice vocabulary related to culture and history (e.g., *bicultural, indigenous, treaty, ancestral, artifact*), and develop reading skills for detail and specific information.
- Socio-cultural: Develop cultural respect by analyzing how New Zealand integrates indigenous culture into modern life, and compare it with the treatment of indigenous cultures in the students' home country (Dialogue of Cultures).

Stage	Stage aim	Timing	Procedure	Aids and materials
Warm-up	Activate background knowledge and introduce the concept of biculturalism.	5 min	Teacher shows a picture of the New Zealand flag and a picture of the Maori flag (Tino Rangatiratanga). Ask: *"What country is this? Why do you think there are two flags?"*	Pictures of the two flags.
Controlled Practice	Pre-teach vocabulary for reading.	7 min	Students match words: *bicultural, indigenous, treaty, to preserve, ancestral, artifact*. Look at the title *"Biculturalism"*. What does it mean? (Two cultures living together equally).	Vocabulary Match, presentation slide
Reading	Develop reading skills for detailed understanding and specific information.	10 min	Students read the extended text . They complete Task 1 (Comprehension Questions) and Task 2	Text and Tasks Te Tiriti o Waitangi – the Treaty of Waitangi | Te Ara

			(Find the Words).	Encyclopedia of New Zealand , Māori | Te Ara Encyclopedia of New Zealand ,Discover Māori culture in New Zealand | 100% Pure New Zealand
Post-Reading	Develop critical thinking and cultural understanding.	8 min	Teacher shows a picture of the Haka (the Maori war dance performed by the All Blacks rugby team). Ask: *"Why do you think a war dance is performed before a sports game? What does it show about their culture?"*	Picture of the Haka.
Freer Practice	Apply knowledge, develop speaking skills through the "Dialogue of Cultures"	15 min	Round Table Discussion. Students work in groups. They discuss the questions. Task 2: Dialogue of Cultures. Compare New Zealand's approach to Maori culture with the approach to indigenous cultures in the students' home country.	Questions
Homework and feedback	Summarize and reflect.	5 min	*"Why is the Maori language (Te Reo) important for New Zealand's identity?"* Homework: Write a short paragraph (50 words): *"What can other countries learn from New Zealand's approach to indigenous culture?"*	Notebooks

Match the words (1-6) with their definitions (A-F).

Word	Letter	Definition
1. Bicultural	[ ]	A. Relating to the original inhabitants of a land (native people).
2. Indigenous	[ ]	B. To keep something safe and in its original condition over time.
3. Treaty	[ ]	C. Relating to two different cultures living together in one society.
4. To preserve	[ ]	D. An object made by a human being, typically of cultural or historical interest.
5. Ancestral	[ ]	E. A formal agreement between two groups (often about land or peace).
6. Artifact	[ ]	F. Relating to your ancestors (people in your family who lived a long time ago).

Vocabulary Match

1. C
2. A
3. E
4. B
5. F
6. D

Aotearoa: A Bicultural Nation
(Adapted from New Zealand History, Tourism New Zealand, and Te Ara Encyclopedia)

New Zealand is often called "Aotearoa" (the land of the long white cloud). It is a unique country because it is a bicultural nation. This means that the culture of the

indigenous Maori people is not just a historical artifact—it is an official part of modern life.

The relationship between the Maori and the British Crown is built on the Treaty of Waitangi, signed in 1840. This treaty promised to protect Maori land, culture, and language. However, the history of the treaty is complex, and there were many conflicts over land. Today, the New Zealand government works to preserve the Maori language (Te Reo Maori). Since 1987, it has been an official language alongside English. You can hear it on TV, in schools, and in the names of cities (like Whangarei or Rotorua).

Maori culture is visible everywhere. The famous Haka (a traditional war dance) is performed by the national rugby team, the All Blacks, before every international game. It is a symbol of strength and unity. You can also visit a marae (a traditional meeting house), where ancestral carvings and artifacts tell the stories of different tribes. For New Zealanders, Maori culture is not just for Maori people—it is the heart of the nation's identity.

Task 1: Read the text and answer the questions.

1. What does the word "Aotearoa" mean?

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2. When was the Treaty of Waitangi signed, and what did it promise?

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3. Since what year has Maori been an official language?

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4. What is a "marae"?

Answers:

1. "The land of the long white cloud."
2. It was signed in 1840. It promised to protect Maori land, culture, and language.
3. Since 1987.
4. A traditional meeting house where ancestral carvings and artifacts tell the stories of different tribes.

Task 2: Find the words in the text.
Find words that mean:

- A. People who are the original inhabitants of a land: _____
- B. A traditional war dance: _____
- C. Relating to your ancestors (family from long ago): _____

Answers:

- A. Indigenous
- B. Haka
- C. Ancestral

Work in groups. Discuss the questions below.

1. The Treaty: The Treaty of Waitangi promised to protect Maori land and culture. Why do you think it is still important today, almost 200 years later?
2. The Haka: The All Blacks perform the Haka before rugby games. Some people say it is a "war dance" and shouldn't be in sports. Do you agree or disagree? Why?
3. Dialogue of Cultures: Does your country have an indigenous population? How is their culture protected or celebrated today? Compare it with New Zealand's approach.

Useful phrases for discussion:

- *From my point of view...*
- *I totally agree with the idea that...*
- *I see your point, but I think...*
- *In my country, for example...*